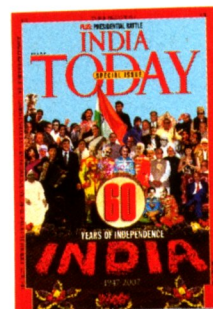
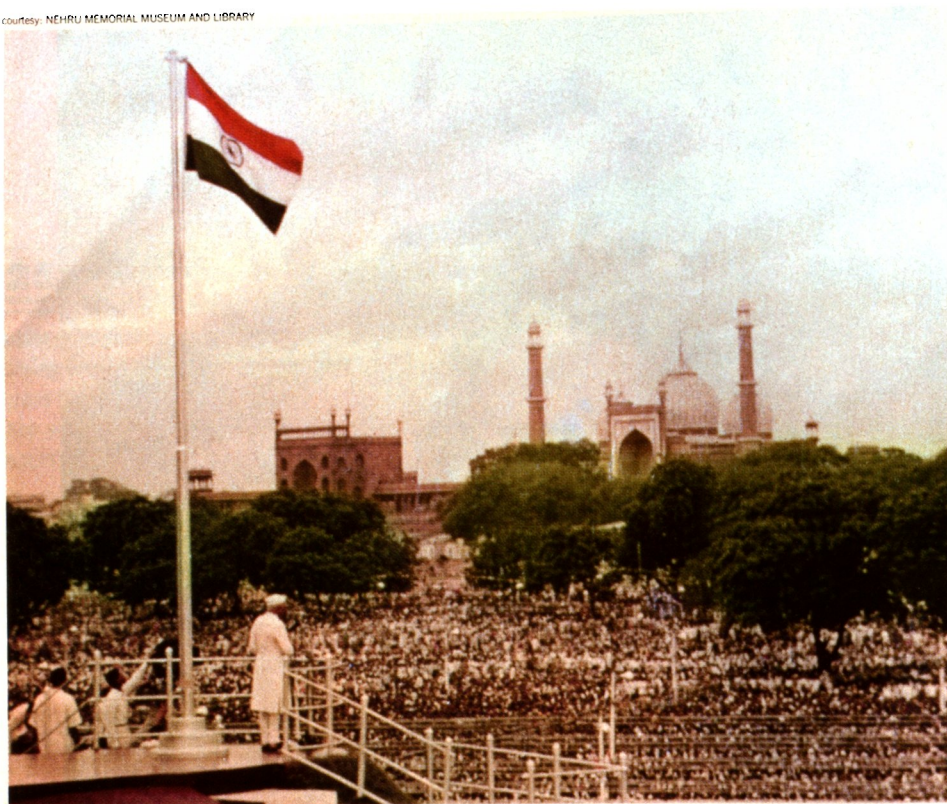


courtesy: NEHRU MEMORIAL MUSEUM AND LIBRARY



"60 Years of Independence",
July 2, 2007

"Schools and colleges in the country should distribute the copies of this weekly free of cost so that the students can take stock of the events of the past."

K. PRADEEP, Chennai

Far from Independence

After 60 years of Independence, India is socially more fragmented today than it was earlier, thanks to the policies followed by our political leadership over the decades ("60 Years of Independence", July 2). We cannot afford to ignore the perils confronting us.

S.C. KAPOOR, Noida

The special issue has put forward the roller coaster journey of India, post-Independence, in such a lucid manner that it will serve as a good reference book.

ANUSHA SINGH SAHARAN, Delhi

It is wonderful to see that a nation which couldn't even produce safety pins 60 years ago, has now evolved into a global power. Your special issue is the proof of this phenomenal growth.

K. CHIDANAND KUMAR,
Bangalore

The issue couldn't have come at a better time. The result of 60 years of Independence is: people's representatives trying to outdo the people's President.

S. BALAKRISHNAN, Jamshedpur

The cover photograph of the issue was disappointing. It is neither creditable nor justifiable to show Mahatma Gandhi in any attire other than what he used to wear.

ASHOK BHATT, on e-mail

The cover picture of the issue is a straight lift from the Beatles' "The Sgt Pepper" album cover. Has the magazine run out of ideas?

DIVYA GANGADHARAN, Mumbai

Does INDIA TODAY have some hidden acrimony against former prime minister P.V. Narasimha Rao. Not only did he not feature on the cover, he was covered poorly too.

B. MURALI MOHAN, Hyderabad

Roots of Discord

The seeds of communalism and fundamentalism, sowed in 1947, have now grown into trees of terrorism ("A Divided Dawn", July 2). We are still paying for that with our lives.

MAYANK BAROLIA, on e-mail

The Right Judgement

Indeed, one of the achievements of the insipid 1950s was the establishment of an unbiased judiciary ("Looking Back, for Lessons", July 2). The courts have only proved the hindsight of those leaders correct.

V.C. BHATNAGAR, Kanpur

Mistaken Interpretation

It is unfortunate to see that there are people who look back at the 1960s with an air of nostalgia ("An Area of Darkness", July 2). We have come a long way from the misfortunes heaped on us by the past rulers.

T.S. PATTABHI RAMAN,
Coimbatore

Tallest Among Them All

Despite her many follies and failures, Indira Gandhi has been the most remarkable of the country's prime ministers ("The Rise, Fall and Rise of Indira Gandhi", July 2). India, nay the world, is yet to produce a leader of her stature.

VIRENDRA KUMAR TANGRI,
Dehradun

Religious Rivalry

The magazine correctly identifies the 1980s as an era when people were identified by their religious associations ("The Great Indian Political Churning", July 2). Religion and regional divide have now become the base of all political parties and their ultimate desire is to get votes by appeasing communal sects.

DEEPAK BHATIA, Delhi

Caste-ing a Net

The 1990s will forever be remembered for the seeds